

Pastoral Landscape with Ruins, 1664

Adriaen van de Velde (Dutch, 1636-1672)

Oil on canvas / 67 x 78.4 cm unframed; 81.3 x 92.4 x 6.4 cm framed

REPORT INFORMATION

DATE OF EXAMINATION	2026-06-12
EXAMINER NAME	Sarah Whitmore, Registrar
PURPOSE OF CONDITION CHECK	Incoming consignment check prior to exhibition and sale
LOCATION	Condit Fine Art, 14 Albemarle Street, London W1S 4HW

ARTWORK DETAILS

ARTIST	Adriaen van de Velde (Dutch, 1636-1672)
TITLE	Pastoral Landscape with Ruins, 1664
MEDIUM	Oil on canvas
DIMENSIONS	67 x 78.4 cm unframed; 81.3 x 92.4 x 6.4 cm framed
STOCK CODE / REFERENCE	CFA-2026-0147

ARTWORK CONDITION

CONDITION

Fair

DEFECTS OBSERVED

Losses, Previous repairs visible, Cracks / craquelure

NOTES

Overall the painting is in stable condition consistent with its age. A fine network of age craquelure is present across the entire surface, most pronounced in the sky at upper right where the crack pattern is slightly raised but not actively flaking. Two small areas of old retouching are visible in the masonry of the ruins at centre left, discoloured and readily apparent under UV examination. Scattered pinpoint paint losses in the dark foreground passage at lower left, the largest approx. 3 mm, with associated abrasion to the impasto highlights on the cattle. The canvas has an old glue-paste lining, taut and in plane, with no evidence of recent movement. Varnish is moderately discoloured with a slightly uneven gloss but is not actively degrading. No mould, tears or deformation noted.



Recto, overall, normal illumination

- 1 Raised craquelure across sky, stable, no active flaking
- 2 Discoloured retouching in masonry, fluoresces dark under UV
- 3 Scattered pinpoint losses, largest approx. 3 mm

FRAME CONDITION

CONDITION

Fair

DEFECTS OBSERVED

Gilding losses, Previous repairs

NOTES

Carved and gilded frame, probably 19th century, not original to the painting. Gilding losses along the top rail and at the lower left corner exposing red bole, the largest approx. 15 x 8 mm. Old corner repair at upper left with a hairline open mitre, currently stable. Bronze-paint overgilding on the inner slip is slightly tarnished. Fixings, hanging hardware and backboard are sound; backboard was removed and refitted during examination.

OVERALL CONDITION

SUMMARY NOTES

The work is fit for display and transport in its current state. Condition issues are long-standing and stable; no treatment is required before exhibition, although the discoloured retouchings and varnish could be addressed by a conservator if the consignor wishes. Recommend re-examination on release. Photographed under normal illumination; UV examination carried out, raking light photographs on file.

PACKING REQUIREMENTS

Soft wrap (acid-free tissue plus Dartek), corner protectors, then double-wall cardboard for local transit. For any onward shipping a fitted travel frame or museum crate with Tyvek lining is required given the raised craquelure in the sky. Keep upright at all times, glazing-free so no glass tape needed. Climate target 18-22 C, 45-55% RH. Do not pack within 24 hours of any surface treatment.

SIGN-OFF

SIGNATURE



Recto, overall, normal illumination

- 1 Raised craquelure across sky, stable, no active flaking
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Detail, lower left foreground, area of pinpoint losses

- 1 Largest loss, approx. 3 mm, exposing ground layer" (dark scrub below the cow)
- 2 Abrasion to impasto highlights



- 1 Old retouching, discoloured, visible in normal light

detail, ruins at centre left, old retouching



detail, sky upper right, raised craquelure



detail, upper left corner, paint layer and frame rebate edge